

287 Search for soil insects

2
HRS

The soil is teeming with tiny insects, many so small you'd never notice them. With this simple funnel, though, you can discover what bugs live under your feet.

What you need

- Paper towels
- Wide jar
- Soil
- Plastic funnel 6–7 in (15–17 cm) wide
- Coarse mesh
- Desk lamp

1 Dampen two sheets of paper towels, fold them, and put them in the bottom of the jar. Crumple mesh into the funnel.

2 Add garden soil and shine the lamp over it for 2 hours.

3 The heat from the light will cause bugs in the soil to move through the mesh into the jar. See how many you've collected, then let them go.



288 Distract an ant

20
MINS

Find an ant trail in your yard. Put a sugar cube to one side of the trail. See how long it takes the ants to find the sugar. Try this with different groups of ants. Which finds the bait the fastest?

